Sample Email

Subject: Urgent: Unusual sign-in activity on your Microsoft account
From: Microsoft Account Security <security-alert@micr0soft-support.example>
To: user@example.com
Date: 6 November 2026 (fictional example)
Message: Hello, We noticed an unusual sign-in attempt on your Microsoft account. To avoid temporary account restrictions, review your account activity immediately. Review your account: https://account.microsoft.com/security Thank you, Microsoft Account Support
Training note: The displayed link in this simulated example is intended to differ from its fictional hover destination: https://microsoft-account-check.example/login. Do not visit it.

1. Objective

To examine a Microsoft-themed email example and identify common phishing indicators such as a suspicious sender address, urgency, and a mismatched link.

2. Investigation and Findings

Check	Observation	Result
Sender address	The domain uses “micr0soft” with the number zero and is not an official Microsoft domain.	Suspicious
Email headers	No original .eml file or full message headers are provided for this simulated example. SPF, DKIM and DMARC cannot be verified.	Not tested
Links / attachments	The example contains a link whose fictional hover destination differs from the displayed URL. No attachment is shown.	Suspicious link
Urgent language	The message says to review account activity immediately to avoid account restrictions.	Present
URL mismatch	Displayed: account.microsoft.com/security. Fictional destination: microsoft-account-check.example/login.	Mismatch
Spelling / grammar	The wording is grammatically clear. Good spelling does not prove that an email is genuine.	No obvious errors

3. Conclusion

The simulated email contains phishing indicators: a look-alike sender domain, pressure to act quickly, and a mismatch between the displayed link and its destination. These features make the message suspicious. The example is suitable for demonstrating content-based checks, but it does not provide genuine email headers; therefore, it cannot be used to claim that SPF, DKIM or DMARC failed.

4. Recommended Safety Actions

Do not click the link or reply. Open the Microsoft account website by typing its known address directly into the browser, and report suspicious messages to the organization's IT/security team. For a complete header-analysis exercise, obtain an actual .eml sample containing original headers and analyze those headers with an email-header analyzer.